

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Shutdown threatens funds for home heat

Millions of families expected to suffer during cold weather

By Susan Haigh and Marc Levy
Associated Press

HARTFORD, Conn. — Jacqueline Chapman is a retired school aide who relies on a \$630 monthly Social Security check to get by. She was navigating the loss of her federal food aid benefits when she learned the assistance she receives for heating her Philadelphia apartment may also be at risk.

“I feel like I’m living in scary times. It’s not easy to rest when you know you have things to do with limited accounts, limited funds. There isn’t too much you can do,” she said.

Chapman, 74, relies on the \$4.1 billion Low-Income Home Energy Assistance Program, which helps millions of low-income households pay to heat and cool their homes.

With temperatures beginning to drop in areas across the United States, some states are warning that funding for the program is being delayed because of the federal government shutdown, now in its fifth week.

The anticipated delay comes as a majority of the 5.9 million households served by the federally funded heating and cooling assistance program are grappling with the sudden postponement of benefits through the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, or SNAP, which helps about 1 in 8 Americans buy groceries. Money is running out for other safety net programs as well, and energy prices are soaring.

“The impact, even if it’s temporary, on many of the nation’s poor families is going to be profound if we don’t solve this problem,” said Mark Wolfe, executive director of the National Energy Assistance

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INSIDE

Bears defeat Bengals in dramatic final minutes

With seconds remaining, Bears quarterback Caleb Williams zipped a pass to tight end Colston Loveland, who raced his way to the end zone for a 58-yard touchdown. **Chicagoland Sports**

Jeff Tweedy rejuvenated in Chicago concert

The singer-songwriter’s show at the Salt Shed was a homecoming to savor, with songs suggesting the need to pause and reflect on joys, mysteries, losses and memories. **Arts & Living**

Blitz linked to dip in 911 calls

Chicago data shows rate decrease sharpest in Mexican American Little Village area

By Sam Charles, Laura Rodríguez Presa and Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

The rate of 911 calls made in Chicago has dropped precipitously in the two months since the start of Operation Midway Blitz, a Tribune review of city data found.

And nowhere is the decrease more pronounced than in Little Village, home to Chicago’s largest Mexican American population, where calls to 911 have fallen by more than 21% since the surge

of federal immigration officers began, city data show.

Neighborhood leaders acknowledge a sharp year-over-year decline in crime, but note that the wave of immigration enforcement has left many residents in fear of calling 911 for help during that stretch.

The decline reflects more than just safer streets in Little Village, said Matt DeMateo, executive director of New Life Centers, a nonprofit serving youths and families in Little Village. It’s residents’ fear, fueled by federal immigration enforcement, that may be driving the decline.

“It’s less about trust in police, it’s more about fear,” DeMateo said. “ICE is creating chaos, and

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Traffic moves along 26th Street near the Little Village gateway arch in Chicago on Friday. Calls to 911 from the neighborhood have fallen by more than 21% since the surge of federal immigration enforcement began, city data shows. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



Dayanne Figueroa, a U.S. citizen, stands in her mother’s backyard in Northlake on Oct. 26. An unmarked vehicle driven by federal agents collided with Figueroa’s car as the agents tried to speed away from a hostile crowd, videos reviewed by the Tribune show. **EILEENT. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

‘In shock and terrified’

Federal agents struck a Chicago woman’s car, then dragged her out and detained her. Now she’s demanding accountability

By Laura Rodríguez Presa and Jonathan Bullington
Chicago Tribune

Dayanne Figueroa was on her way to get coffee before heading to work when she encountered a chaotic scene in West Town: heavily armed, masked federal agents making arrests on a residential street.

People yelled as vehicles honked their horn — a sign now used to alert neighbors that immigration federal agents are in the

area — and witnesses said federal agents had arrested several landscaper workers presumed to be in the country without authorization.

As Figuero tried to drive through the 1600 block of West Hubbard Street on Friday, Oct. 10, an unmarked vehicle driven by federal agents collided with Figueroa’s as it tried to speed away from a hostile crowd, multiple videos reviewed by the Tribune show.

Seconds after the crash, agents

abruptly stopped their vehicle and exited with weapons in hand pointing at Figueroa, a U.S. citizen. Agents then forcibly opened her door and pulled her out of the vehicle by her legs without identifying themselves, presenting a warrant or informing her that she was under arrest. As bystanders yelled, “You hit her! We have it on video!” agents ignored the crowd and forced Figueroa into a red minivan and drove away.

Her car was left behind in the middle of the road, her coffee still in the cup holder, and her keys in plain view.

The Department of Homeland Security later released a statement claiming that Figueroa was at fault, saying “she crashed into an unmarked government vehi-

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- Nonprofit aids street vendors hurt by immigration crackdown, **Chicagoland, Page 3**
- Day of the Dead event honors man killed by ICE agent, **Page 7**
- Anger over ICE raids stirs Latinos to vote, **Nation & World**
- Immigration agent punches restrained man in video of Evanston arrest, **Nation & World**

cle and violently resisted arrest, injuring two officers.”

Figueroa was released the same day a few hours later without charges.

Figueroa’s arrest highlights growing concerns about the

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CTA Blue Line trains roll along the rails as vehicles move along the Eisenhower Expressway in Chicago on Friday. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Lawmakers avert transit service cuts, layoffs with funding bill

Deal raises \$1.5 billion, overhauls system with new governing body

By Talia Soglin, Olivia Olander and Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

For months, Illinois transit leaders warned of a doomsday scenario that would hobble the region’s mass transit systems.

Dozens of bus lines were on

the chopping block, they warned, along with whole portions of the “L.” Thousands of workers faced the threat of layoffs. Transit advocates warned that service cuts would have wide-ranging consequences for the Chicago economy and the environment.

As of Friday morning, that scenario seems to be in the rear-view mirror.

After multiple failed legislative proposals, state lawmakers finally got a transit funding deal across the finish line in the early-morn-

ing hours on Friday. Gov. JB Pritzker said he intends to sign the measure into law.

In addition to raising around \$1.5 billion, the deal will overhaul the Chicago region’s mass transit system by creating a new governing body to oversee the CTA, Metra and Pace called the Northern Illinois Transit Authority.

The deal includes various initiatives intended to bolster safety on the region’s transit

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